

Author's Greeting

Thank you for taking the time to read this definition document.

Core Stabilization is a term that appears frequently in the fields of training, rehabilitation, and movement education.

Despite its widespread use, it is often understood not as a coherent whole, but as a collection of fragmented elements—such as muscles, cues, exercises, or subjective sensations.

This document was created to address that ambiguity.

Core Stabilization is also commonly discussed by drawing analogies to human developmental processes.

However, it is rare to encounter an attempt to organize Core Stabilization systematically along the actual course of human development.

In this document, Core Stabilization is therefore organized according to the human developmental process, and its variations and functional effects are examined for completeness through the Eight-Axis Structure.

This book was not written to introduce a new method or to recommend any specific training approach.

Rather, its intention is to clarify what Core Stabilization means when it is understood structurally, independent of techniques, equipment, or instructional styles.

The framework presented here reflects long-term observation across a wide range of movements and practical contexts.

Over time, my interest has shifted away from asking how a movement should be performed correctly, and toward understanding how stability is organized, how it changes under different conditions, and how it can be described without relying on subjective interpretation.

Accordingly, this definition document should be regarded not as a manual to be followed, but as a reference for thinking.

It invites the reader to step back from immediate instructions and to consider the underlying structures that support posture, movement, and adaptability.

It is my hope that this document will bring clarity to areas that have often been a source of confusion, and will provide structure to concepts that are frequently explained in a fragmented manner. If it encourages more precise observation and thoughtful dialogue regarding Core Stabilization, then the purpose of this document will have been fulfilled.

Preface

This definition document was written for readers who sense that Core Stabilization is important, yet difficult to describe with precision.

Across training, coaching, and movement education, the term is widely used, but its meaning often shifts depending on context, method, or personal interpretation.

In many practical settings, Core Stabilization is explained through cues, exercises, or anatomical emphasis.

While these approaches may be effective within specific frameworks, they do not always provide a stable reference for comparison, evaluation, or discussion across different practices. As a result, Core Stabilization can become a vague or overloaded concept, understood intuitively but defined inconsistently.

The purpose of this document is not to resolve those differences by proposing a single correct method.

Instead, it aims to clarify Core Stabilization at a structural level—by defining what can be observed, organized, and evaluated regardless of technique, equipment, or instructional style.

To achieve this, the document introduces several key perspectives. Human developmental processes are used as a reference axis, not to reproduce infant movement, but to organize stabilization patterns in a consistent and comprehensive manner.

Structural axes and models are employed to describe how stabilization functions across posture, movement, and conditions, without reducing it to isolated muscles or exercises.

This document is intended to be read as a conceptual reference rather than a practical manual.

Readers are not expected to apply its content directly as instruction. Instead, it is designed to support clearer observation, more precise discussion, and more deliberate decision-making within existing practices.

Some sections may feel abstract, particularly for those accustomed to exercise-based explanations.

This is intentional.

By temporarily stepping away from concrete techniques, it becomes possible to examine the underlying structure that connects diverse movements and methods.

Readers may approach this document selectively.

Some may focus on the conceptual chapters, while others may return primarily to the definitions and structural frameworks.

There is no required reading order beyond the general progression presented.

Ultimately, this definition document serves as a foundation.

It establishes a shared structural language for Core Stabilization, upon which practical models, educational materials, and applications may later be built.

Its value lies not in instruction, but in clarity.

It is my hope that this work supports thoughtful practice by first supporting clear understanding.

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Chapter 1

The Sixteen Exercises

This chapter presents the complete and fixed reference set of the KFW Core Stabilization exercises.

The purpose of this chapter is not to explain how to perform these exercises,

nor to prescribe training sequences, progressions, or instructional methods.

Instead, it establishes the definitive scope of what is included in KFW Core Stabilization.

The exercises listed below represent a structurally defined collection

of core stabilization tasks.

They are organized using the human developmental process as a reference axis

for verification and structural clarity,

not as a developmental model to be reproduced.

All subsequent chapters in this document should be read as analytical

and explanatory layers applied to this predefined exercise set.

Supine Phase (3)

1. Dead Bug —

A task that maintains trunk stability while alternating contralateral limb movements in a supine position

2. Happy Baby Pose —

A task that examines pelvic and trunk stability in a hip-flexed supine position

3. Glute Bridge —

A task that maintains pelvic and trunk stability in a hip extension position

Rolling Phase (2)

4. Supine Hip Crossover —

A task that maintains trunk stability during lower-limb rotational movement in a supine position

5. Segmental Roll —

A task that examines continuous trunk stability during segmented rotational movement of the body

Prone Phase (4)

6. Cobra Pose

Variation: Upward-Facing Dog —

A task that maintains trunk stability while accompanying spinal extension in a prone position

7. Plank —

A task that maintains trunk stability under conditions of a limited base of support

8. Side Plank —

A task that maintains lateral trunk stability in a side-support position

9. Airplane

Variation: Shoulder Mobility Y / T / W / L —

A task that performs upper-limb movement while maintaining trunk stability

Quadruped Phase (3)

10. Quadruped Rocking —

A task that maintains trunk stability during anterior-posterior weight shifting in a quadruped position

11. Bird Dog —

A task that maintains trunk stability while lifting contralateral upper and lower limbs in a quadruped position

12. Downward-Facing Dog —

A task that maintains trunk stability in a supported position derived from quadruped posture

Half-Kneeling Phase (2)

13. Half-Kneeling Hold —

A task that statically maintains trunk stability in a half-kneeling position

14. Half-Kneeling Rotation —

A task that maintains trunk stability while performing trunk rotation in a half-kneeling position

Standing Up Phase (2)

15. Half-Kneeling to Stand —

A task that maintains trunk stability during the transition from half-kneeling to standing

16. Squat to Stand —

A task that maintains trunk stability during the transition from deep flexion to standing

Note on Variations

Variations are included solely to clarify the functional scope and structural boundaries of specific exercises.

They are not intended to indicate progression, difficulty scaling, or additional exercise categories.

The presence of a variation does not expand the total number of core stabilization exercises defined in this document.

Chapter 2

Concept of This Definition Document

Core Stabilization refers to the function by which the muscles of the trunk (core) work in coordination to maintain bodily stability and balance, serving as the foundation for limb movement.

This function is essential for maintaining proper posture and performing efficient movement. By the coordinated action of deep muscles such as the transversus abdominis, diaphragm, and pelvic floor muscles, intra-abdominal pressure is increased, stabilizing the spine and pelvis, suppressing unnecessary bodily distortion during limb movement, and contributing to improved movement performance.

However, there is no widely unified framework regarding how Core Stabilization should be organized, evaluated, and practiced.

In many cases, explanations remain limited to individual muscles, specific exercises, or experience-based interpretations, making it difficult to examine the overall structure and completeness of exercise systems.

KFW Core Stabilization presents one solution to this issue by structuring and defining adult core stabilization using human developmental processes as a common reference axis.

The developmental process employed here is not intended to reproduce infant movements, but rather to serve as an organizational axis for evaluating adult exercises and improving their quality.

By adopting developmental processes as a reference axis, this system enables a high degree of freedom in practice without reliance on specialized equipment, while simultaneously ensuring both diversity and structural completeness of the exercise repertoire.

Furthermore, this definition document incorporates verification through the Eight-Axis Structure, allowing examination of whether the presented exercise groups are structurally coherent and free from omission or bias.

The purpose of this definition document is not to recommend specific exercises.

Instead, it aims to present Core Stabilization as a structure that can be understood, organized, and verified, rather than something dependent on sensation or experience.

Chapter 3

Scope and Boundaries

This definition document addresses Core Stabilization as a functional and structural concept in adult physical practice. Its primary focus is the organization, definition, and evaluation of Core Stabilization within the context of exercise, movement, and physical training.

The scope of this document is limited to adult Core Stabilization. Although human developmental processes are used as a reference axis, this work does not aim to describe, evaluate, or assess infant or child development itself.

Developmental stages are employed solely as an organizational framework for understanding and structuring adult Core Stabilization.

This definition document does not provide medical diagnosis, therapeutic intervention, or rehabilitation protocols. It is not intended to replace professional medical judgment, nor does it address pathology, injury treatment, or clinical decision-making.

Furthermore, this work does not advocate specific training methods, proprietary exercise systems, or particular schools of thought.

Individual exercises are presented only as representative examples within a structural framework, not as prescriptions or recommendations.

The purpose of defining these boundaries is to prevent misinterpretation and overextension of the concept of Core Stabilization.

By clearly delineating what this document does and does not address, Core Stabilization can be examined as a structural function—one that can be understood, organized, and evaluated independently of technique preference, equipment choice, or instructional style.

Within these defined boundaries, this document aims to provide a consistent and verifiable framework for discussing Core Stabilization, forming the foundation for the structural models, evaluation criteria, and practical relationships presented in subsequent chapters.

Chapter 4

Structural Axes for Core Stabilization

In order to define Core Stabilization as a structural function rather than a collection of exercises or muscular actions, it is necessary to establish clear analytical axes.

Without such axes, discussions of Core Stabilization tend to rely on isolated criteria—such as specific muscles, postures, or sensations—making systematic evaluation and comparison difficult.

In this definition document, Core Stabilization is examined through multiple structural axes.

These axes are not intended to increase conceptual complexity, but to prevent oversimplification and ambiguity.

Each axis represents a distinct perspective from which Core Stabilization can be observed, organized, and evaluated, allowing the concept to remain coherent across different postures, movements, and exercise selections.

The structural axes introduced here function as reference coordinates rather than performance metrics.

They do not judge whether an exercise is “good” or “bad,” nor do they prescribe correct technique.

Instead, they clarify **how** Core Stabilization is being expressed, **where** it is being challenged, and **under what structural conditions** it is maintained.

By applying these axes, Core Stabilization can be discussed independently of specific training environments, equipment, or instructional styles.

The same stabilization function may appear differently depending on posture, movement direction, or task demand, yet still be understood as part of a single, continuous structure.

These axes also serve a critical role in ensuring structural completeness.

When Core Stabilization is viewed through multiple, independent axes, it becomes possible to verify whether an exercise system adequately represents the full range of stabilization demands, or whether certain conditions are unintentionally omitted or overemphasized.

The following section introduces the Eight-Axis Structure, which integrates these perspectives into a unified framework.

This structure provides the foundation for the structural models and evaluation frameworks presented in subsequent chapters, enabling Core Stabilization to be treated as a definable, examinable, and reproducible concept.

Chapter 4.2

The Eight-Axis Structure

The Eight-Axis Structure is a unified framework for examining Core Stabilization as a structural function.

Rather than relying on a single dominant criterion, this structure organizes

Core Stabilization through eight independent yet complementary axes.

Each axis represents a distinct structural perspective through which stabilization can be observed, organized, and examined.

The purpose of the Eight-Axis Structure is not to rank performance or determine correctness.

Instead, it provides a consistent reference system for identifying how

Core Stabilization is expressed, challenged, and maintained under varying conditions.

When viewed through a single criterion, Core Stabilization tends to be reduced to isolated elements such as specific muscles, postures, or sensations.

By contrast, the Eight-Axis Structure prevents such reduction by allowing stabilization to be examined simultaneously from multiple independent perspectives.

The eight axes are defined as follows.

The Posture Axis identifies the body posture conditions under which Core Stabilization is expressed.

The Spatial Axis describes the directional orientation of stabilization demands acting on the body.

The Functional Axis clarifies the functional role that stabilization serves

within a given task.

The Developmental Axis uses human developmental processes as a reference for structural classification, without implying reenactment or progression.

The Muscle-Role Axis examines stabilization in terms of muscular roles rather than individual muscles.

The Breathing Phase Axis describes the relationship between breathing phases and stabilization, without prescribing breathing techniques.

The Thoracic Mobility Axis addresses the relationship between thoracic mobility and structural stability, recognizing that mobility and stability can coexist.

The Core Stability Axis represents the integrated state of trunk stabilization

resulting from the interaction of the other axes.

Individually, each axis provides a partial perspective on Core Stabilization.

When combined, they form a comprehensive framework that enables systematic organization, evaluation, and verification of stabilization structures.

The Eight-Axis Structure serves as the foundational reference for the structural models and evaluation frameworks presented in the following chapters, ensuring consistency and coherence throughout this definition document.

Chapter 5

Core Stabilization Structural Models

The purpose of introducing structural models is to translate abstract structural axes into interpretable configurations.

While the Eight-Axis Structure defines the perspectives through which Core Stabilization can be examined, structural models describe how these perspectives interact to form recognizable stabilization states.

In this definition document, a structural model is not an ideal form or a prescribed technique.

Instead, it represents a stable organizational pattern in which Core Stabilization is maintained under specific conditions.

Multiple models may coexist without hierarchy, as each reflects a different structural arrangement rather than a level of performance.

Structural models are derived by observing how the eight axes align under particular postural, functional, and developmental conditions.

When certain axes converge in a consistent manner, a recognizable stabilization structure emerges.

These models provide a practical bridge between conceptual structure and observable stabilization behavior.

Importantly, structural models do not correspond to individual exercises.

An exercise may express different structural models depending on posture, movement intent, breathing phase, or task demand.

Conversely, the same structural model may appear across a wide range of exercises and movements.

The role of structural models is threefold.

First, they support organization.

By grouping stabilization expressions into structural models, complex variations can be discussed without excessive fragmentation.

Second, they support evaluation.

Structural models make it possible to assess whether Core Stabilization is being maintained consistently under given conditions, without relying on subjective sensation or isolated muscular criteria.

Third, they support communication.

By referring to shared structural models, practitioners can discuss Core Stabilization with clarity and precision, even when specific exercises or methods differ.

The structural models presented in this chapter are intended to function as reference patterns.

They do not represent fixed stages, progressions, or goals.

Rather, they provide a framework for understanding how Core Stabilization can be organized, sustained, and adapted across varying contexts.

In the following chapter, these structural models will be further examined through a developmental and state-based perspective, allowing stabilization to be discussed in terms of structural states rather than linear progression.

Chapter 6

Developmental and State-Based Perspective

This definition document adopts a developmental and state-based perspective to further clarify the structure of Core Stabilization.

This perspective is not intended to describe chronological growth, maturation, or skill acquisition.

Instead, it provides a conceptual framework for understanding Core Stabilization as a set of structural states that can appear, disappear, and reappear depending on conditions.

From a developmental perspective, human movement patterns emerge through interaction between posture, gravity, and environmental demands.

These patterns reveal fundamental stabilization structures that precede complex, goal-oriented movement.

In this document, such developmental patterns are used as reference points for organizing adult Core Stabilization, not as stages to be reenacted or progressed through.

The state-based perspective emphasizes that Core Stabilization is not a fixed attribute.

Stabilization exists as a state that varies according to posture, task demands, breathing conditions, and movement intent.

An individual may demonstrate a stable structure under one condition while showing a different or unstable structure under another, without implying regression or deficiency.

By combining developmental reference and state-based interpretation, Core Stabilization can be examined without assuming linear progression or hierarchical advancement. Structural states are treated as configurations that are condition-dependent rather than level-dependent.

This perspective allows Core Stabilization to be discussed independently of training history, age, or proficiency. A given stabilization state may appear in beginners and experienced practitioners alike, depending on contextual demands rather than accumulated skill.

The developmental and state-based perspective also supports objective evaluation.

Rather than judging performance as correct or incorrect, stabilization can be examined in terms of which structural state is

present, how consistently it is maintained, and under what conditions transitions occur.

In this framework, change in Core Stabilization is understood as a shift between structural states, not as movement along a fixed developmental ladder.

This understanding provides the conceptual foundation for the evaluation and judgment framework presented in the following chapter.

Chapter 7

Evaluation and Judgment Framework

This chapter presents a framework for evaluating Core Stabilization based on structural observation rather than performance scoring or technical correctness.

The purpose of evaluation in this document is not to determine whether an exercise is performed correctly, but to identify and describe the structural state of Core Stabilization under given conditions.

Within this framework, evaluation is conducted by examining how Core Stabilization is expressed across the established structural axes.

Assessment focuses on the presence, consistency, and sustainability of stabilization structures, rather than on isolated muscular activation or subjective sensation.

Evaluation is therefore descriptive rather than prescriptive.

It seeks to answer questions such as:

Which structural state is present?

Under what conditions does it appear or change?

How consistently is it maintained during posture transitions or task demands?

Judgment within this framework does not imply ranking, grading, or pass-fail classification.

Instead, judgment refers to the process of determining whether the observed stabilization structure aligns with the intended structural conditions of a given task.

Different stabilization structures may be equally valid depending on posture, movement intent, and environmental demands.

This approach avoids binary evaluation.

Core Stabilization is not treated as simply present or absent, correct or incorrect.

Rather, it is examined along a continuum of structural expression, allowing subtle differences and transitions to be identified without assigning value-based labels.

The evaluation framework also emphasizes reproducibility.

A stabilization structure is considered meaningful when it can be consistently observed under similar conditions, regardless of the specific exercise or instructional context.

This criterion supports objective discussion and reduces reliance on anecdotal or subjective judgment.

Importantly, this framework separates evaluation from instruction. Evaluation identifies and describes structural states; instruction and coaching decisions may follow, but they are not embedded within the evaluation itself.

This separation preserves the neutrality and applicability of the framework across different practices and methodologies.

By establishing a clear evaluation and judgment framework, Core Stabilization can be examined as a definable and observable structure.

This framework provides the basis for relating structural understanding to practical application, which is addressed in the following chapter.

Chapter 8

Relationship to Practice

This chapter clarifies how the structural understanding of Core Stabilization presented in this definition document relates to practical exercise and training.

The purpose is not to prescribe methods or techniques, but to explain how structural definitions can inform and support practical decision-making.

In practice, Core Stabilization appears within concrete movements, tasks, and exercises.

However, the same exercise may express different stabilization structures depending on posture, intent, breathing condition, or task demand.

Conversely, similar stabilization structures may be observed across a wide variety of exercises that appear unrelated at the surface level.

The framework presented in this document allows practice to be viewed through structure rather than form.

Instead of asking whether an exercise is correct, effective, or advanced, practitioners can examine which stabilization structure

is being expressed and under what conditions it is maintained or disrupted.

This relationship supports adaptability in practice.

Because Core Stabilization is defined independently of specific exercises or equipment, practitioners are free to select, modify, or combine exercises according to context while maintaining structural consistency.

Changes in environment, load, or instructional style do not invalidate the structural framework.

The separation between evaluation and instruction remains essential in practical application.

Structural evaluation identifies the stabilization state present in a given situation.

Instruction, coaching, or programming decisions may then be made based on that information, but those decisions lie outside the scope of this definition document.

By maintaining this distinction, the framework can support diverse practices without enforcing uniform methods.

Different practitioners may apply the same structural understanding in different ways, reflecting individual goals, constraints, and preferences.

Ultimately, the relationship between structure and practice is bidirectional.

Structural definitions inform practice by providing clarity and consistency, while practical observation reinforces structural understanding by revealing how stabilization states manifest under real conditions.

This chapter establishes the conceptual bridge between definition and application, preparing the ground for addressing common misunderstandings in the following chapter.

Chapter 9

Common Misunderstandings

Because Core Stabilization is often discussed using simplified or experience-based explanations, several common misunderstandings tend to arise.

This chapter addresses these misunderstandings in order to clarify the intent and scope of the framework presented in this definition document.

One common misunderstanding is that Core Stabilization refers to the strength or activation of specific muscles.

While muscular activity is involved in stabilization, Core Stabilization as defined here is not reduced to individual muscles or isolated contractions.

It is understood as a structural state that emerges from the coordinated organization of posture, movement, breathing, and functional demand.

Another misunderstanding is that Core Stabilization implies rigidity or bracing at all times.

In this framework, stabilization does not require constant stiffness.

Controlled mobility, adaptability, and appropriate variation are compatible with stable structural organization, depending on task conditions.

A further misunderstanding is the assumption that Core Stabilization follows a linear progression from “basic” to “advanced.”

This definition document does not treat stabilization as a developmental ladder or skill hierarchy.

Structural states are condition-dependent and may appear or change based on posture, intent, or environment rather than accumulated proficiency.

It is also commonly assumed that specific exercises inherently produce Core Stabilization.

In reality, no exercise guarantees a particular stabilization structure.

The same exercise may express different structural states, and similar states may emerge across different exercises, depending on how conditions are organized.

Another source of confusion is the use of developmental terminology.

The reference to human developmental processes in this document does not imply reenactment, imitation, or regression to infant movement.

Developmental patterns are used solely as a structural reference axis for organizing and comparing adult stabilization states.

Finally, Core Stabilization is sometimes interpreted as a corrective or therapeutic intervention.

This document does not present Core Stabilization as treatment, diagnosis, or rehabilitation.

Its purpose is definitional and structural, providing a framework for understanding and evaluation rather than clinical decision-making.

By addressing these common misunderstandings explicitly, this chapter aims to protect the integrity of the framework and ensure that Core Stabilization is interpreted as intended:

a structural concept that can be examined, discussed, and applied without reduction to technique, sensation, or isolated anatomy.

Chapter 10

Definitions and Terminology

This chapter provides standardized definitions of key terms used throughout this definition document.

The purpose of these definitions is not to introduce new terminology unnecessarily, but to ensure consistency, clarity, and precision in how Core Stabilization is discussed and interpreted.

The terms defined here are used in a structural and contextual sense.

Unless otherwise specified, they should not be assumed to carry clinical, therapeutic, or method-specific meanings.

Core Stabilization

Core Stabilization refers to the structural state in which the trunk is organized to maintain stability and control under given conditions, allowing posture and movement to be coordinated without structural breakdown.

In this document, Core Stabilization is not defined by specific muscles, exercises, or techniques, but by the organization and interaction of multiple structural factors.

Structure

Structure refers to the organized relationship among posture, movement, breathing, muscular roles, and environmental demands that gives rise to a stable or unstable state.

A structure is observable through its effects and consistency rather than through isolated components.

Structural State

A structural state is a condition-dependent configuration in which Core Stabilization is expressed.

Structural states are not hierarchical levels or stages of progression, and they may change according to posture, task demands, or environmental context.

Structural Axis

A structural axis is an analytical perspective used to examine a specific aspect of Core Stabilization.

Axes function as reference coordinates, allowing stabilization to be observed, organized, and evaluated without prescribing technique or performance standards.

Eight-Axis Structure

The Eight-Axis Structure is a unified framework composed of eight structural axes that collectively describe Core Stabilization as a multidimensional phenomenon.

It is used to verify structural completeness and coherence, not to rank performance or determine correctness.

Structural Model

A structural model represents a recurring organizational pattern in which multiple structural axes align under specific conditions.

Structural models are reference configurations rather than ideal forms, techniques, or goals.

Developmental Reference

Developmental reference denotes the use of human developmental processes as an organizational axis for structuring and comparing adult Core Stabilization.

It does not imply reenactment, imitation, or assessment of developmental stages.

Evaluation

Evaluation refers to the descriptive identification of the structural state of Core Stabilization under given conditions.

Evaluation in this framework focuses on presence, consistency, and sustainability rather than correctness or quality judgment.

Judgment

Judgment refers to the determination of whether an observed structural state aligns with the intended structural conditions of a given task.

Judgment does not involve grading, ranking, or prescriptive decision-making.

Practice

Practice refers to the application of movement, exercise, or training in real contexts.

Within this document, practice is considered the domain in which structural states are observed, not where structural definitions are created.

These definitions are intended to function as a common language throughout this document.

By standardizing terminology, Core Stabilization can be discussed with precision and consistency, supporting clear communication,

reliable evaluation, and coherent application across diverse practices.

Afterword

This definition document was written to clarify Core Stabilization as a structural concept rather than a collection of techniques, exercises, or cues.

Throughout this work, Core Stabilization has been treated not as something to be strengthened, activated, or perfected, but as something to be understood, organized, and examined.

The motivation for creating this document arose from a recurring difficulty:

while Core Stabilization is widely discussed and frequently emphasized, it is often described in fragmented or ambiguous terms.

Muscles, sensations, exercises, and experiences are commonly cited, yet the underlying structure that connects them is rarely made explicit.

By introducing developmental reference, structural axes, and state-based interpretation, this document seeks to provide a stable framework for discussion without narrowing practice to a single method or ideology.

The intention has never been to replace existing practices, but to offer a common structural language through which diverse practices can be understood and compared.

Importantly, this work does not claim to present a complete or final answer.

Rather, it aims to establish a clear starting point from which meaningful observation, dialogue, and refinement can occur. Structure, once made visible, invites further questioning rather than closure.

If this document succeeds, it will not do so by instructing readers how to move, but by changing how they observe movement.

When Core Stabilization is recognized as a structural state that varies with conditions, posture, and intent, practice becomes less about enforcing correctness and more about cultivating awareness and adaptability.

It is my hope that this definition document serves as a quiet but durable reference—one that supports clarity without restriction, and rigor without rigidity.

In that sense, this work is not an endpoint, but a foundation.

Author's Note

This definition document is part of an ongoing effort to clarify physical fitness not through instruction, but through structure.

This book was written based on the belief that clarity of definition must precede effectiveness in practice.

The exercises in this document are organized and evaluated under the assumption that Core Stabilization can be addressed comprehensively by practicing along six phases of the human developmental process.

Conversely, this structure also allows for an approach in which practice, verification, and refinement are carried out within each of the six phases.

The KFW approach does not begin with methods, cues, or exercises.

It begins with the question of how function can be described in a manner that remains consistent across individuals, situations, and practical contexts.

Core Stabilization was chosen as the subject of this document not because it is novel, but because, despite being widely referenced, it is rarely defined with structural precision.

Throughout this book, emphasis is placed on boundaries.

The scope of what is defined here is intentionally limited—not due to uncertainty, but in order to preserve consistency.

By defining what this framework addresses and what it does not, Core Stabilization can be examined without conflating it with technical preferences, coaching styles, or therapeutic intentions.

This book is not intended to function as a manual, but as a reference.

It does not teach the reader how to train movements, how to instruct others, or how to correct technique.

Rather, it provides a shared structural language that supports more precise observation, discussion, and decision-making across diverse practices.

The concepts presented here are designed to remain stable even as their applications evolve.

Future publications may expand upon practical models, educational materials, or visual representations, but such developments will remain subordinate to the structural definitions established in this document.

If this definition document proves useful, it is likely because it enables readers to understand familiar movements more clearly.

Once recognized, structure does not demand imitation; it encourages understanding.

This book marks an endpoint in definition, not a declaration of completion.

It is offered as a foundation for continued exploration, application, and dialogue.

Author's Position on the Eight-Axis Structure (2026-01-08)

To assess the effects of delicate exercises such as Core Stabilization on the human body,

I consider the perspective of the Eight-Axis Structure to be effective.

At the same time, from my own experience and sensibility, the Eight-Axis Structure is not a perspective that should be applied at all times.

There are situations in which this structure deepens understanding, and other situations in which refraining from its use allows thought to proceed more naturally.

When the Eight-Axis Structure is overemphasized or repeatedly applied in thinking and writing, there is a risk that thought may become fixed or stagnant.

For this reason, at the present stage, I do not establish the Eight-Axis Structure as an independent paper or definition document.

Instead, it is addressed within the context of Core Stabilization, and explained only to the extent that is necessary.

Satoru Hara